

European lobster

Lobsters are crustaceans, a group of invertebrates with armor-like, jointed exoskeletons protecting their soft bodies. One of the largest lobster species, the European lobster lives in shallow coastal seas across most of Europe and northern Africa.

North Sea

The North Sea is the biggest expanse of shallow continental waters in the northeast Atlantic. It is rich in lobsters' favorite food, such as crabs, starfish, and sea urchins.

Long antennae

Lobsters use their antennae to feel their way around on the seabed in murky, dark waters.

North Sea

ATLANTIC OCEAN

Warmer waters

Like many European marine species, the European lobster reaches the southern limits of its range in the waters off the coast of Morocco in northwest Africa. It cannot tolerate the warmer tropical seas further south.

The Azores

This group of small volcanic islands marks the westernmost part of the European lobster's territory.

Uneven-sized claws

The fatter claw of a lobster is stronger for slow crushing, while the slimmer one is better for faster cutting. Both are used for breaking up food or in self-defense.

Lobster movements

Most lobsters migrate into deeper waters to spawn, but one of the most spectacular migrations happens every fall off the coast of the United States, when huge numbers of spiny lobsters move in single file over the seabed to reach their spawning grounds.



KEY

European lobster range